

Skiing

Skiers have been gliding over snow for fun, and to get around, for thousands of years. Skiing became popular as a sport in the 18th century, and there are now two types: **alpine** and **Nordic**.

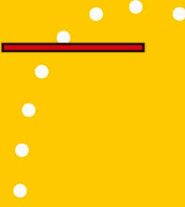


Downhill skiers reach speeds of up to **80MPH (130KPH)**.



Alpine

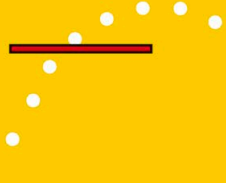
In alpine skiing, skiers glide **down hills**. There are **four events**: downhill, slalom, giant slalom, and super giant slalom (Super G).



Downhill is all about speed. Skiers start near the top of a mountain and rush down a steep, twisty course as quickly as possible.



Slalom is a shorter race for master turners. Skiers make short, quick turns between poles or gates.



Giant slalom skiers race over a longer course between a series of gates. The gates are spaced farther apart than in slalom races.



Super G combines the speed of downhill with the precision skiing of giant slalom.

